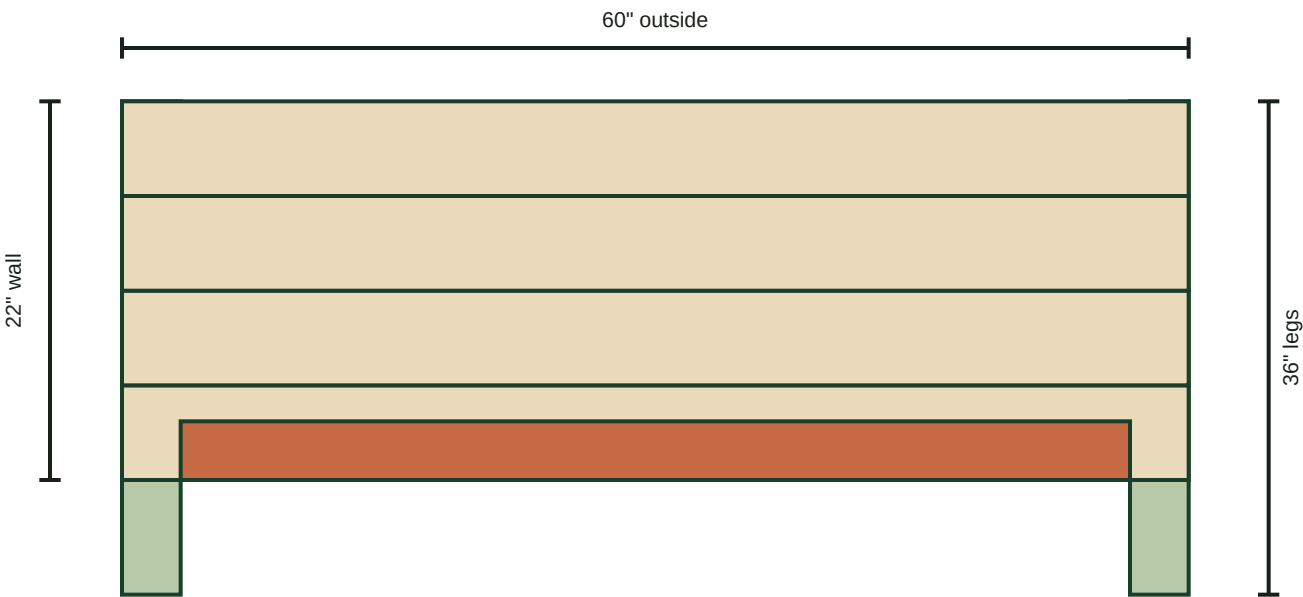


5' x 2' Elevated Cedar Planter Box

A Green Pergola build guide based on the same construction sequence used for the finished planter: 4x4 legs, cedar picket walls, an internal 2x4 bottom frame, and cedar floor slats.

Finished footprint	60" L x 24" W
Leg length	36"
Wall height	22" (4 cedar courses)
Approx. planting depth	17 7/8" to top of bottom slats
Center support	Not needed at 24" width; add at 36"+ width



Long-side elevation. Cedar pickets run across the outside faces of the 4x4 legs. The 2x4 support frame sits inside the walls at the bottom.

Shopping List

These quantities cover the 5' x 2' example and include the wall material plus a practical allowance for the bottom slats. Buy an extra cedar picket if you want a mistake/defect allowance.

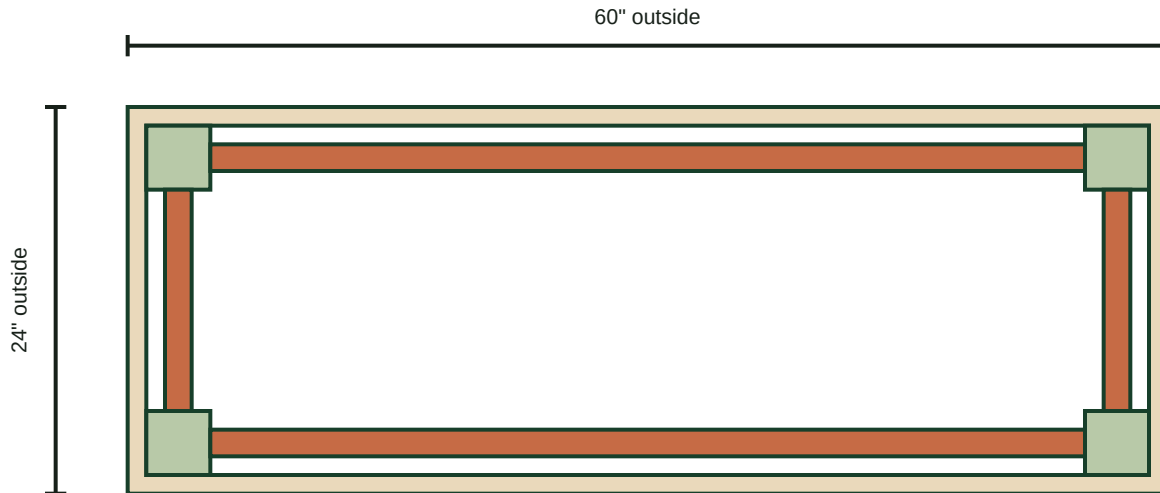
Material	Buy	Used for
4x4 x 12' exterior-rated post	1	Four 36" legs
5/8" x 5-1/2" x 6' cedar pickets	Approx. 15	Walls + bottom slats; see notes below
2x4 lumber	Approx. 12 linear ft	Internal bottom support frame
Exterior/deck screws	As needed	Cedar walls + floor slats
2-1/2" pocket-hole screws rated for exterior use	8 minimum	Two pocket holes at each end of four frame rails

Exact Cut List

Part	Qty	Cut length	Notes
4x4 legs	4	36"	One 12' post yields all four.
Long cedar wall boards	8	60"	Four courses per long side.
Short cedar wall boards	8	24"	Four courses per short side; 3 pieces fit from one 6' picket.
Long 2x4 frame rails	2	53"	Fits between inside faces of 4x4 legs.
Short 2x4 frame rails	2	17"	Fits between inside faces of 4x4 legs.
Cedar bottom slats	Cut to fit	Approx. 22-3/4"	Run across width on top of frame. End slats are notched around

Bottom-slat note: The exact number and final rip depend on the drainage gap you choose and the actual installed inside width. Cut the slats after the box is assembled, test-fit them, then notch the corner pieces around the 4x4 legs. This avoids pretending a nominal lumber dimension is more precise than the assembled planter.

Bottom Support Frame



The outside footprint is 60" x 24". Because a 4x4 is actually 3-1/2" square, the clear distance between the inside faces of the legs is 53" along the length and 17" across the width.

Install the 2x4s **on edge** (1-1/2" horizontal x 3-1/2" tall). Make pocket holes at both ends of each rail and fasten each rail directly into the 4x4 legs. Keep the top of the frame level so the cedar bottom slats have a flat bearing surface.

For planters 36" wide or wider: add a 2x4 center support through the middle of the bottom frame, running lengthwise, to reduce floor-slat span.

Assembly - Step by Step

1. Cut the legs

Cut the 4x4 x 12' post into four 36" legs.

2. Build the two short walls

Cut eight cedar picket pieces to 24". Lay two legs parallel and attach four cedar courses across their outside faces. Repeat for the opposite end. Keep the leg tops aligned and the wall courses tight and square.

3. Install the bottom frame

Stand the two short-wall assemblies upright. Cut two 53" and two 17" 2x4 rails. Drill pocket holes at both ends of every rail. Mount the rails on edge between the legs, with the frame positioned at the bottom of the 22" cedar wall section. Check level and square before fully tightening.

4. Close the long walls

Cut eight cedar pickets to 60". Attach four courses to each long side, running the boards across the outside faces of the 4x4 legs. Work down until the wall reaches the bottom of the 2x4 frame.

5. Measure for the floor

After the walls and frame are assembled, measure the actual inside width. The nominal target is about 22-3/4" between the inside faces of the cedar walls, but build to the measurement in front of you.

6. Cut and install cedar bottom slats

Cut cedar pickets to span the width and lay them across the top of the 2x4 frame. Space them consistently for drainage. Notch the first/last slats around the 4x4 corners where required, then screw the slats into the 2x4 frame.

7. Finish

Sand sharp edges and splinters. Apply an exterior finish if desired and let it cure before filling. Add liner if that is part of your preferred build, then fill with raised-bed soil.

Custom Size Formula

For any planter where the stated length and width are measured to the **outside edges of the 4x4 legs**:

Piece	Formula
Long cedar wall boards	Finished planter length
Short cedar wall boards	Finished planter width
Long 2x4 rails	Finished length - 7 inches
Short 2x4 rails	Finished width - 7 inches
Wall height	Number of cedar courses x actual picket face width
4x4 legs	Desired overall planter height

Because lumber varies and the floor is fitted after assembly, measure the actual inside opening before cutting all bottom slats. For widths of 36 inches or more, add the center 2x4 support.